PATNA, BIHAR

The capital of Bihar sits in the middle of several traditional mango-growing areas. To the east is Bhagalpur with its Zardalu, a thin-skinned and delicate variety suitable for refined dinner tables, for it has little fibre. To the north is Champaran, which has the Zarda, a small and plump mango that is fibrous and juicy. It is so delicate that it is seldom found in markets outside the region. To the northeast of the capital is Darbhanga, a traditional stronghold of horticulture, with all the regional favourites and some unique juicy mangoes for sucking. To the west of Patna is the Digha area, famous for its Malda mangoes.

TRY: A three-hour drive from Patna, Bihar's Darbhanga is where Mughal emperor Akbar had planted one of the country's largest mango groves.



GETTY IMAGES

Siblings in an orchard near Patna



Hazarduari Palace in Murshidabad

SUBIR HALDER

MALDA, WEST BENGAL

Himsagar and Gulabkhas are the two varieties from West Bengal that are known outside of the state. They are opposites of each other. Himsagar has a very sweet and strong, turpentine taste that's not for everyone, especially not those allergic to mango sap. It is one of India's most unique-tasting mangoes. Gulabkhas is a smaller, more refined mango with a thin, red-coloured skin and delicate flesh. West Bengal has numerous wonderful mango varieties not known outside the region. This includes Kishanbhog and Maldah. To enjoy these, you have to travel north of Kolkata, all the way through Murshidabad to the mango powerhouse of Malda district. It produces the last mango of the season, the large and cumbersome Fazli.



The sweet & strong Himsagar

TRY: The Bengal Mango Utsav, a three-day festival held at Kolkata's New Town Mela Festival around early June every year, usually boasts of 400 mango varieties.



Gulabkhas mangoes